

Gaurav Joshi

Product & Transformation Leader · 18 years · Loyalty, Travel, Banking, Media, HRMS · AI Product

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Consultant or product manager, the title has never changed the work: I make sense of the abstract, work through the chaos to something real, and translate it so every function can see it and get behind it. The journey below is page one; the skills and the ideas behind it follow.

THE PROFESSIONAL JOURNEY

Nihilent Technologies

Enterprise Transformation
Consultant

Feb 2008 – May 2015

7 years

South Africa, India & UK

- **Banking Association SA – strategy execution**

Built strategy maps and balanced scorecards across org, division and individual levels, plus a competency-assessment system - objectives down to KPIs, formulae and ground-level rollout, delivered through **LAMAT (strategy execution)** and **CAS (competency assessment)**. Studied as a WITS University case study.

- **Customer Loyalty Evaluation (CLE) – idea to market**

Was on the initial concept-to-commercialize team that launched CLE from concept to client PoCs and an internal employee loyalty-evaluation survey; built the analysis framework that became the final client-report template, and ran minimal-cost market research (an MBA winter project) to set pricing and generate leads - **all inside 12 months**.

- **Standard Bank – process optimization & P2P contact centre**

Business case to a live centralised-procurement call centre, **PoC stood up in 3-5 months** as a contractor and scaled nationally as Project Prologue. **CIPS Southern Africa Best Process Improvement award**.

- **M-Net & SuperSport – system & process re-engineering**

7 consecutive enterprise releases over 2.5 years on a content-contracts, media and scheduling system; built a new reporting and analysis module inside a legacy on-prem product with no BI investment.

Cybage Software

Solution Architect

May 2015 – Feb 2020

~5 years

Pune, India

- **Leave Management System – internal product launch**

Idea to launch in **18 months**. Introduced a decision-table framework for complex rules and edge cases that was **adopted as best practice across product teams**.

- **Foundational platform – RBAC & rules engine re-engineering**

Product owner for core platform components; translated abstract architectural vision into implementation-ready specs, securing **architectural stability and cross-functional sign-off**.

JPMorgan Chase

VP, Product Management –
Travel & Loyalty

Feb 2020 – Present

6+ years

Pune, India

- **\$25M/month platform – on-prem to cloud**

Migrated 5 enterprise clients across 3 launches in **12 months, zero downtime, zero critical defects**; shipped a new UI and 0 → 1 features - guest flow, new forms of payment. **100% client adoption; enabled the firm's data-centre exit**.

- **FIFT – supplier-error standardisation (taken over)**

Inherited a stalled workstream and drove it to outcome: 38 standardised categories, **support alerts down 50%, booking failures down 30%**.

- **Multi-state dark-pattern compliance – MA, FTC, CA, TX**

Built the governance and drove **15+ product teams to 100% compliance** inside the mandated window, with no line authority.

- **Compliance discovery → action**

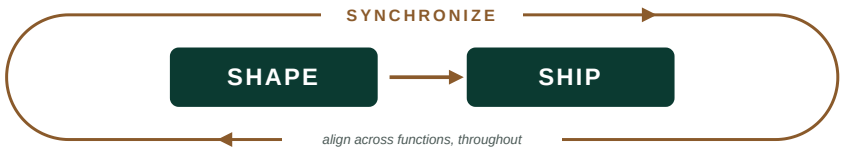
Read compliance documents against customer feedback and risky terms; surfaced concrete work - **simplified cancellation terms for Lodging**, and a concept for an **AI-based proactive non-compliance identifier**. Won executive budget for a PoC.

THE SKILLS RUNNING THROUGH EVERY ENGAGEMENT

Product strategy & discovery · 0 → 1 innovation · stakeholder management & influence without authority · digital transformation · regulatory compliance · cross-functional leadership - grounded in the full delivery craft: requirements & elicitation, BRD/FRD, use cases, functional & non-functional specs, UAT and adoption. **Waterfall and Agile - I have shipped in both.**

Shape · Ship · Synchronize

The role doesn't matter - consultant or product manager, the skillset is the same and only the problems change. I make sense of the abstract, work through the chaos to something real, and translate it so every function can see it and align behind it. Every project on page one came out of these same three moves.



Shape flows into Ship; Synchronize wraps both - the same craft whichever hat I wear.

SHAPE	SHIP	SYNCHRONIZE
Make sense of the abstract	Work through the chaos	Align across functions
Problem discovery & framing	Requirements & BA craft	Stakeholder management
0 → 1 / greenfield product	Backlog & delivery leadership	Influence without authority
Customer & market research	Platform / cloud migration	Executive buy-in & funding
Business case & GTM strategy	Agile product management	Change management
Framework invention	Hands-on AI / RAG build	Coaching & mentoring

RECOGNITION & THOUGHT LEADERSHIP

AI Trustworthiness Matrix An original framework (built on NIST AI RMF) for scoring how far an AI system can be trusted - each dimension rated for quality and for how confident you are in that rating, turning opinion into a measured, prioritised fix-list. Proved on my own Safari build.	PKVit prioritisation framework Scores features on a painkiller-to-vitamin spectrum - how sharply each relieves real pain versus how much it merely adds - to force a clean ranking when everything looks urgent.
Goal-based travel-package framework A first-of-its-kind multi-criteria and affinity scoring model, backed by 100-user primary research. No known market equivalent.	AHP-based content scheduling Applied the Analytic Hierarchy Process - a statistical multi-criteria model - to a scheduling decision people were arguing from opinion. Authored as a white paper.
IIBA Product Ownership Analysis guide Officially credited contributor to the IIBA's global CPOA guide - a standard the profession builds on.	Speaker, IPA Summit – 'The Sherlock Way' On simplifying complex business processes for intelligent process automation - a method turned into a talk.

AWARDS & CREDENTIALS

CSPO	CBAP	CIPS Best Process Improvement	Outstanding Alumni Award	WITS case study	SAFe POPM
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Personal projects

AI has turned me into a hands-on, accelerated product builder - I take my own ideas from 0 to 1, solo. Built, shipped and public.
github.com/GSJ24983

Safari AI Assistant

A multimodal assistant for Tata Safari owners: ask a question in plain language, **or upload a photo of a dashboard warning light**, and get an answer grounded only in the official service and infotainment manuals - so it explains, it doesn't hallucinate.

Built solo, end to end: a manual-ingestion pipeline → semantic search over a vector store I generate from the manuals → **Google Gemini** for multimodal reasoning across text and image → a Streamlit app, deployed live on Streamlit Cloud. **The full stack - retrieval, grounding, the image path, the deployment - is mine.** I then used it as the first test case for my AI Trustworthiness Matrix (page 2), so I know precisely where it is strong and where it is not.

github.com/GSJ24983/safari-ai-assistant · safari-ai-assistant-gsj24983.streamlit.app

ALPHA · LIVE · MULTIMODAL RAG

Puppeteer – scenario-based learning engine A branching-scenario engine that teaches judgment by making people decide, then grading what they write - reasoning, not multiple choice. My case-solving coaching method, the weekly forum I've run across three organisations, turned into a working tool. github.com/GSJ24983/puppeteer-sbl	Marathi words The small build behind my daily project reviving forgotten Marathi words - one archaic word a day, my own reading of it, as shareable cards. Where the writing habit meets the framework habit. github.com/GSJ24983/marathi-words
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Off the clock: I write - poems and short stories, and the Marathi project above. Also football, family, and a slow campaign against the flute. The same instinct that invents frameworks at work, pointed somewhere quieter.